

Log Cabin Block, Intermediate Class Handout

Valley Youth Center Quilting, Wednesdays 2:00 to 4:00 PM

Instructor: Lisa Hoffman Session: October 14, 2026

About the block

The log cabin is built around a center square, traditionally red for the hearth. You add strips, the logs, around that center, working light on two sides and dark on the other two. The light and dark split is what makes the pattern read once the blocks are joined.

What to bring

Center fabric (red), a set of light fabrics, a set of dark fabrics, rotary cutter, ruler, mat, and your machine thread. We will work to a 1/4 inch seam throughout.

Cutting list (one 10 inch block)

Piece	Strip	Cut size
Center	Red	2.5 in by 2.5 in
Log 1	Light	2.5 in by 2.5 in
Log 2	Light	2.5 in by 4.5 in
Log 3	Dark	2.5 in by 4.5 in
Log 4	Dark	2.5 in by 6.5 in
Log 5	Light	2.5 in by 6.5 in
Log 6	Light	2.5 in by 8.5 in
Log 7	Dark	2.5 in by 8.5 in
Log 8	Dark	2.5 in by 10.5 in

Steps

1. Sew Log 1 to the center, press out.
2. Turn the block a quarter turn counterclockwise after each log so you always add to the same side.
3. Keep the two light logs together and the two dark logs together as you go around.
4. Press after every seam. Pressing is half of piecing.
5. Check that the block measures 10.5 inches raw before you call it done.

Take your time. A straight seam beats a fast one. We will join four blocks next week.